Lessons Learned Log

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This log records each mistake or gap that a review found, its cause, and a rule that stops it from happening again. Read it at the start of each sprint. Add new items at the bottom. Do not delete items.

Sprint 2 technical review (Oct 23, 2026)

ID	What happened	Root cause	Fix	Prevention rule
L01	An AI summary that said "not Red" passed the status check (G1).	The check looked for the status word only. Nobody tested an answer that uses the word in the wrong way.	SRG-34	For each AI guardrail, write a test that tries to trick it (a negation, a different status, a key that is not in the input).
L02	A line break in a ticket title broke the Markdown table (B1).	The random tests checked that each section exists, not that each table is complete.	SRG-35	Survival checks test the structure of the output (row and cell counts), not only that a heading exists.
L03	Raw HTML in a title went into the Markdown file without escaping (B2).	Only the HTML report escaped text. The Markdown report escaped only "|".	SRG-35	Treat each output format as untrusted output. Escape all text from Jira in each format.
L04	The project status reason had no length limit (B3).	The rule was tested with 1 or 2 tickets only.	SRG-36	Test each text output with a large week (40 or more tickets).
L05	The tickets went to Done before their pull requests were merged (P1).	One approval for many tickets, with no fixed order of steps.	SRG-37	Merge first, then Done. Claude merges after the approval and then moves the ticket (D39).
L06	Code for SRG-25 and SRG-26 was committed under SRG-23 (P2).	The code was easier to write in one place, and the stacked branches hid the mix.	SRG-37 (record only)	Each commit holds only the work of its own ticket. If code belongs to a later ticket, it waits for that ticket's branch (D39).
L07	All 8 tickets were In Progress at the same time (P3).	The request "move all to In Progress" was followed literally.	SRG-37 (record only)	At most 2 tickets In Progress. A ticket moves to In Progress only when its work starts (D39).
L08	6 Sprint 2 decisions were not in the Decision Log (P4).	The decisions were made inside the code and the pull requests, not discussed as decisions.	SRG-37	Each pull request lists its decisions. Each one goes into the Decision Log before Review (D39).
L09	The RAG Rules and AI Guardrails pages did not match the code (P5).	The code changed, but the pages did not change in the same ticket.	SRG-37	A ticket that changes a rule also changes its page. This is a Definition of Done item (D39).

ID	What happened	Root cause	Fix	Prevention rule
L10	The RAID Log was not reviewed at the Sprint 2 review (P6).	The review checked the delivery, not the governance pages.	SRG-37	Each sprint review has a checklist: tickets, Decision Log, RAID Log, rule pages, README (D39).
L11	The README did not explain the new functions (P7).	The README work was planned for the end (SRG-29).	SRG-29	Update the README in the same ticket as the function. SRG-29 only completes it.
L12	The CI tested one Python version; no Dependabot; actions pinned by tag.	The CI was set up for the minimum (SRG-16).	SRG-37	Test each supported Python version. Keep dependency alerts on. Pin actions to a commit.

Fix work for the Sprint 2 review (Oct 23, 2026)

ID	What happened	Root cause	Fix	Prevention rule
L13	The SRG-34 code was written while SRG-34 was still To Do. The move to In Progress failed, and the work started.	The Jira call returned an error (wrong parameter name), and the work did not wait for the result.	SRG-34 moved to In Progress before its pull request. SRG-35 and SRG-36 moved first.	Check the result of each status move. Start the work only after Jira shows In Progress.

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L14	After SRG-34, the AI evaluation gave 4 of 5: "on track" in a Red week. The failing text was not visible.	The D41 soft-word check covered only sentences with "project". The unit tests used only the patterns we expected. The evaluation printed no text.	SRG-38 (D44)	Run the AI evaluation set before an AI ticket goes to Review, not after the merge. Each tool that reports a failure shows the data that failed.

ID	What happened	Root cause	Fix	Prevention rule
L15	The real run removed the AI summary: "not in the agreed form". The evaluation set had passed 5 of 5.	The AI wrote JSON as free text. The evaluation samples had clean titles; real titles have quotes. The first real AI run came only at the end of the project.	SRG-40 (D49): reasons in the warning, a sample with difficult titles. The tool schema was not the final fix. The final fix is structured outputs (D50, see L16).	Use a fixed output schema for each AI answer that code reads. Run the AI once on real data in the sprint that adds the AI, not at the end. Copy real-data cases (quotes, long text) into the evaluation set.

ID	What happened	Root cause	Fix	Prevention rule
L16	The first SRG-40 fix used a forced tool call. Real run 2 failed with a 400 error, and the warning showed only "BadRequestError".	The API feature was chosen from memory, and its model limits were not checked in the current documentation. The fake API in the tests accepts each parameter, so the tests passed. The warning dropped the API message.	SRG-40 (D50): structured outputs, and the API status and message in the warning.	Before using an API feature, read its current documentation for the model in config.yaml. A test checks the request against the documented limits. Each error shows the message from the service.

ID	What happened	Root cause	Fix	Prevention rule
L17	The next real run removed the AI summary: "the answer stopped at the output limit (600 tokens)".	The model used thinking tokens, and these count against the output limit. The limit was set from the length of the text only.	SRG-40 (D51): low effort and an output limit of 2,000 tokens.	Set each output limit from the documented token use of the model, with thinking. Read the token use in the first real run.
L18	The AI summary needed 4 real runs and 3 fix rounds before it worked (Sprint 3 retrospective).	Each fix found only the next problem. Only the product owner could do a real run, so each round waited for a manual run. There was no written checklist for an AI feature.	Sprint 3 actions A9, A10, A11.	Use the delivery skill with the AI feature checklist (A9, A10). Add a manual GitHub Actions job for the evaluation, with the key as a secret (A11).